and compare them to those you assumed earlier.

The revisit exercise is an opportunity to ensure that your investments remain aligned with your risk tolerance. Moreover, just because money seems to be tight, it doesn't mean you need to abandon your financial goals. You may consider taking on additional work to supplement your income, or working for a few more years and postponing your retirement. You may also sell some of your unwanted, yet valuable possessions to reduce debt or increase investments. You may delay certain goals; however, non-negotiable goals should not be tampered with. Your child's college education is a non-negotiable goal, and you cannot change the year when they finish school to enter college.

However, you can delay goals such as upgrading your car or travelling abroad for a vacation. The goal-revisit exercise allows you to juggle the limited monies you have to invest towards each of your financial goals. Ideally, a well-crafted financial plan doesn't require much tinkering. However, given the extended climate of uncertainty, a little flexibility around your goals will prepare you to face other financial challenges that life may throw at you.

↘ DECISION DILEMMA

Don't be burdened by trying to make many financial decisions at one go. Instead of aggregating allocations to expenses and investments, consider financial commitments individually. Try tackling them one at a time and stagger your decisions on addressing the issues. Emotions play a vital role in our lives, and they easily influence us. People are known not to touch investments made in their children's name or their spouse's name.

Emotions are neither good nor bad, and it is impractical to be emotionless—rather, it is important to understand the emotions driving your decisions. Be clear about where your feelings are coming from, so you can look at things as realistically as possible. Remember that emotions may be temporary, but the emotional impact of your financial decisions can be permanent or difficult to change. When it comes to financial decisions, it is better to consult with an expert who will not let your emotions harm the financial decisions you make. Emotions can lead to anxiety, which is fast impacting lives *(see Coping with Financial Anxiety).*

↘ STAYING INVESTED

When market conditions are uncertain, or market returns aren't as impressive as you had imagined, it is natural for you to be worried. Although history shows that time is on the side of the long-term investor, not everyone has time, nor does every goal. Take, for instance, someone approaching retirement in 2027 with a significant retirement corpus invested in equities. It is for these reasons that it is important to take the long view and trust the financial strategy built around your risk tolerance, time horizon and goals.

A well-diversified portfolio, with a balanced mix of investments and asset classes, can also help lessen the risk of loss against prolonged market volatility. Volatility is an investment term for periods when

ONCE YOU HAVE CUT EXTRA EXPENSES OUT OF YOUR BUDGET, GO BACK AND REVISIT YOUR ESSENTIAL EXPENDITURES ONE LAST TIME

COPING WITH FINANCIAL ANXIETY

The increase in the cost of living is leading to more financial stress, impacting not just finances but also mental health

